



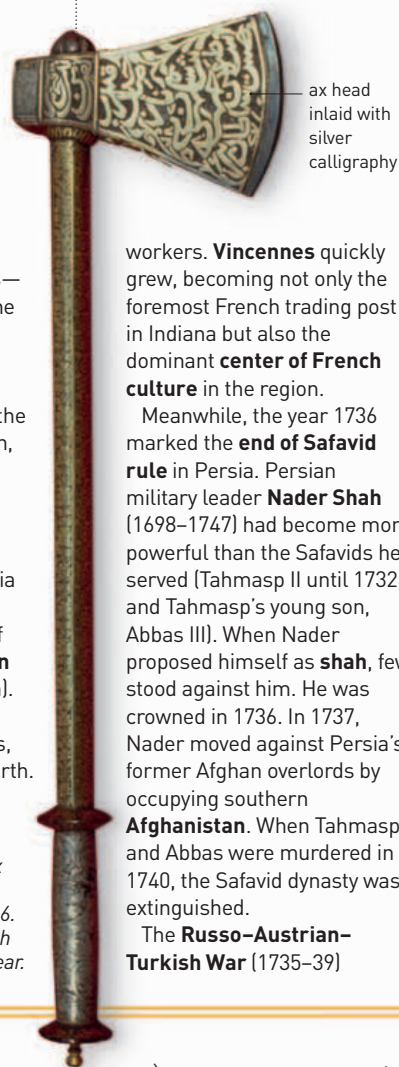
An illustration depicting sugar processing in the Caribbean from *Histoire des Antilles* by French clergyman and plantation owner Jean-Baptiste Labat.

CHARLES MARIE DE LA CONDAMINE (1701–74), French explorer, scientist, and mathematician, joined an expedition to Peru in 1735. After falling out with his colleagues, he continued alone to Quito, Ecuador, from where he traveled down the **Amazon** to Cayenne, thereby making the first scientific exploration of the river. Returning to Paris in 1744, he published the journal of his travels and discoveries in 1751. When in **Ecuador**, La Condamine was the first European to encounter **rubber**—the Mayans had been making flexible rubber for centuries—and in 1736 he introduced the product to Europe when he sent sheets of processed rubber to Paris.

By the early 18th century, the Portuguese, Spanish, British, French, and Dutch had **slave-worked sugar plantations** in Brazil and throughout the Caribbean. In 1735, the French East India Company began to develop plantations on the islands of **Ile-de-France** and **Bourbon** (now Mauritius and Réunion). Soon to follow was the first **sugar refinery** on Mauritius, built at Ville Bague in the north.

Weapon of conquest

This finely decorated battle-ax belonged to Nader, who was crowned shah of Persia in 1736. He led the Persians to war with Afghanistan in the following year.



In North America, pressure from expanding British colonies forced the French to strengthen their claim to **Indiana** by establishing a **permanent settlement**. In 1732, a trading fort had been erected at the site of present-day Vincennes, but in 1735 the traders were joined by a wave of agricultural

workers. **Vincennes** quickly grew, becoming not only the foremost French trading post in Indiana but also the dominant **center of French culture** in the region.

Meanwhile, the year 1736 marked the **end of Safavid rule** in Persia. Persian military leader **Nader Shah** (1698–1747) had become more powerful than the Safavids he served (Tahmasp II until 1732, and Tahmasp's young son, Abbas III). When Nader proposed himself as **shah**, few stood against him. He was crowned in 1736. In 1737, Nader moved against Persia's former Afghan overlords by occupying southern **Afghanistan**. When Tahmasp and Abbas were murdered in 1740, the Safavid dynasty was extinguished.

The **Russo–Austrian–Turkish War** (1735–39)

signaled that no treaty could easily end the War of the Polish Succession (see 1733). In addition, Russia, joined by Austria in 1737, intended to seize the **Crimea** and gain access to the Black Sea, at the same time ending raids by Crimean **Tartars**. One Russian army captured part of the Crimea in 1736, but was forced by disease to retreat. Another army recovered **Azov** from the Ottomans in Romania and advanced to **Jassy** (Iasi), Moldavia. In 1737, renewed Russian gains in the Crimea were reversed due to a lack of supplies.

By 1737, the **Maratha Empire** in India (see 1728) was enjoying its greatest **expansion** to the north, at the expense of the Mughal Empire. Peshwa (prime minister) **Bajirao I** (r. 1721–40) masterminded this expansion, but almost as powerful as the Peshwa were Maratha chieftains called Sardars—among them Gaekwads of Baroda, Shindes of Gwalior, and Holkars of Indore—who established their own kingdoms in the captured lands.

In 1737, Swedish taxonomist and botanist **Carolus Linnaeus** (1707–78) published *Genera Plantarum*, later joined by *Species Plantarum* (1753). Along with his earlier *Systema Naturae* (1735), these works laid the foundation for the system of biological classification still used today.

Plant anatomy

Carolus Linnaeus's *Genera Plantarum* classified plants by their sex organs—the numbers of stamens and pistils in their flowers.



1735 Carolus Linnaeus publishes first edition of *Systema Naturae*

April 1735 French explorer La Condamine embarks on expedition to Peru

1735 Vincennes, Indiana, is established on Wabash River

October 3, 1735 Signing of Preliminary Peace ends fighting in War of the Polish Succession

October 8, 1735 Qianlong succeeds Yongzheng as Qing emperor of China

March 8, 1736 Nader Shah, founder of Afsharid dynasty, crowned shah of Persia

June 19, 1736 Russian army seizes Azov, Romania, from Ottomans

1736 La Condamine sends first samples of processed rubber to Europe

June 30, 1737 Russian army storms Ottoman fortress of Ochakov, Romania

July 1737 Austria joins Russia in its war with the Ottomans but suffers several defeats

July 1737 Russian army defeats army of Crimean Khan but withdraws due to lack of supplies

1737 Carolus Linnaeus publishes first edition of *Genera Plantarum*